

Peter Drucker, Management Expert wisely observed, "A weed is a weed until a new use is found for it," Drucker was an authority on innovation and opportunity recognition. He challenged that we check out ideas, even seemingly worthless things can have value if their potential is recognised and realized through new uses and/or applications.

WHAT OPPORTUNITIES COULD YOU BE SITTING ON?



A Report on Irish Farm Succession and Future Opportunities.

Studies on the dynamics of Irish farm succession have identified that it is a complex, time sensitive multi-role dynamic (landholder, spouse, successor, non-hereditary siblings, incumbent spouse) each with their own worries about current and future needs.



As of 2020, according to the CSO Farm Census, just 7% of Irish farmers are aged under 35 and 33% are aged 65 or over, 38% of which have yet to identify a successor. Previous studies have also shown that these worries, when combined with a lack of communication due to fear and stress lead to a culture of taboo and secrecy (cf. Kennedy “Farm Succession in Modern Ireland” 1991).



Regular Communications (sometimes in the form of family meetings to ensure all members feel that they are listened to) to foster family member input into future farm innovation to catalyze untapped potential of the farm through the adoption of new technology, new farming methods, new part time enterprises co creating the future in the decade or more BEFORE succession would be formalized. This would provide clear, transparent governance and operational roadmap for smooth generational renewal.



Succession affects economic efficiency, impacts social structure and at an individual level it has profound implications for interpersonal relationships, marriage prospects, domestic accommodation and end of life care. Managing intergenerational transfer within the farming context is daunting but worthwhile.



Defuse the cultural taboo and de-stress the inherent secrecy associated with generational renewal at an intra-family level through regular communication. Facilitate deep, honest conversations to enable empathy, participation and co-creation in understanding roles for the future on or off the family farm.

